MARCUS AURELIUS
Perfumes

NOT FOR EVERYONE.
THAT'S THE POINT.

COMPANY PORTFOLIO · 2026

MARCUSSCENT.COM · INFO@MARCUSSCENT.COM
AMMAN, JORDAN

CONTENTS

WHAT IS IN THIS DOCUMENT

This is the full record behind the company: the reasoning, the figures, the two years that produced the first bottle, and what the numbers actually say. The website states the case. This states the evidence.

THE BUSINESS IDEA

PROBLEM

The niche perfume market is split between two extremes. At one end sit the original, high-quality niche houses, priced at $300 and above. At the other sit cheap niche-styled brands that cut corners on oil quality in order to compete on price, selling the appearance of niche without the substance of it.

There is no middle ground offering real craftsmanship without exploitation. A buyer who wants a composition that was actually developed rather than copied has to pay for a European house's overheads to get it.

SOLUTION

Marcus Aurelius breaks that binary with exclusive, non-derivative blends, carefully selected oils, and fragrances engineered to be magnetic through composition alone, without relying on banned or synthetic pheromone additives.

The claim that the cheap end cuts corners on oil quality is one this company is in a position to make, because it did the opposite and can show what that cost: two years, more than thirty formulations and 1,800 JOD spent before a single bottle was sold. Section 04 sets out exactly where that went.

UNIQUE VALUE PROPOSITION

This is not a perfume made to please everyone, and it is not meant to be wearable by everyone. That exclusivity is the point: a selective fragrance built for a defined identity, not a mass-market crowd-pleaser.

What cannot be copied quickly is not the formula but the time. Anyone can buy the same oils tomorrow. Nobody can buy two years of iteration, and a serious trial cannot be hurried, because a single one takes forty days to finish.

TARGET CUSTOMERS

People who want distinction, not just a pleasant scent: buyers looking for individuality, a story, a persona, and quiet confidence before they are looking for a smell. In practice this is a buyer who already knows what mass-market fragrance smells like on everyone else, and has decided against it.

A perfume that has to announce itself has already lost the *argument.*

COMPANY OVERVIEW

Industry	Location	Stage
Luxury niche fragrance, Eau de Parfum concentration.	Amman, Jordan. Online-first, with no physical retail location at present.	Private soft launch complete. Public launch pending final photography.

SERVICES

Design and production of exclusive, limited-batch fragrances, each with its own visual identity and narrative: **Maxima**, **Maximus**, **Romeo di Roma** and **Roma Juliette**. Everything from composition to packaging to the sales channel is held in-house.

WHAT THE COMPANY ACTUALLY DOES

It develops fragrance compositions from raw oils, macerates and bottles them in small batches, designs the identity and packaging around each one, and sells them directly to the customer with no intermediary anywhere in the chain. It is a manufacturer and a retailer at once, deliberately, because the two roles are what most brands give away and what this one keeps.

THE FOUNDING STORY

It began as a coffee-shop conversation between two friends: why does no fragrance carry these particular notes, and why not make one ourselves? There was no brand in mind. There was curiosity, and a rooftop.

2 YEARS	30+	40 DAYS	1,800 JOD
Before a single bottle was sold	Formulations tried and rejected	For one serious trial to finish	Spent before any revenue existed

The manufacturing videos were discouraging: industrial machines the size of rooms, the kind of equipment that makes the whole idea look closed to anyone without a factory. Then came the discovery that the houses actually worth their price still work by dropper, blend by hand, and leave a composition to macerate somewhere naturally cool. Simpler. And far more expensive, because what the machine replaces is time, and doing it by hand means paying that time back.

The first year went on finding a source. When one was found, European and reached through a Swiss intermediary, the first order of oils cost 500 JOD, and the blending was done in drinking glasses.

More than thirty formulations followed. One smelled good but sat oily on the skin. One burned the nose. One was gone by midday. One smelled like everything already on the shelf. A serious trial takes FORTY DAYS: a week frozen, then thirty days in darkness at a steady 16 to 19 degrees. The rooftop provided that for nothing, which is the reason two years was affordable at all.

The second year cost 1,300 JOD: new notes, dyes, better equipment, and alcohol rectified to **100%** where most perfumery, French houses included, works at 96%. A litre of it costs roughly ten times as much.

Specialists advised starting with cheap oils and buying the good ones once the formula worked. **That advice was refused.** The same note from a cheaper source is a different composition made a different way, and it shows in how long it lasts and in how it sits on the nose of someone wearing it all day. A formula proved on cheap oil is a formula proved on the wrong material. A compromise made at the start is not undone later.

THE ACCIDENT THAT PRODUCED THE FIRST BOTTLE

Romeo di Roma came out of a coincidence. Headphones on while his friend slept, a throwaway song playing, and one word in it stuck: *pineapple*. A note the niche houses use often, and one already sitting among the materials. It went in with caramel and vanilla.

He wore it into the street. The compliments that came back were not expected. **Only then did it become a brand.** The two years came first, spent on something intended for nobody but themselves; the company is what happened when other people reacted to it.

> *The rooftop belonged to the friend from that first conversation, who kept him company through most of it, and whose house is the reason the maceration conditions cost nothing. The company itself is built and run by Abdullah Al-Sallal.*

DEVELOPMENT, IN DETAIL

The portfolio claims elsewhere that the cheap end of the niche market cuts corners on oil quality. This section is the evidence that this company did not, and what refusing to cost.

WHERE THE MONEY WENT

RESEARCH AND DEVELOPMENT, BY YEAR

YEAR	WHAT IT BOUGHT	JOD
Year one	First order of Swiss-brokered niche oils. Trials blended in drinking glasses; no equipment purchased at all.	500
Year two	Additional notes and new accords, dyes, semi-professional equipment, proper bottles, and 100% rectified alcohol.	1,300
Total spent before any revenue existed		**1,800**

THE FORTY-DAY CYCLE

A composition cannot be judged on the day it is mixed. What it smells like in the glass and what it smells like on skin a month later are different things, and the difference is where most formulations fail.

ONE TRIAL, START TO VERDICT

STAGE	DURATION	CONDITIONS
Blending	One session	By dropper, by hand, in small volume
Freezing	7 days	To settle and clarify the blend
Maceration	30 days	Darkness, steady 16–19°C
Total per serious trial	**40 days**	**Before it can be assessed at all**

Thirty-plus formulations at forty days each would be over three years if they were run one after another, and only two were available. They were not run in sequence: batches overlapped, and the ones that failed obviously, the blend that burned the nose or sat oily in the glass, were killed at mixing rather than given a month of rooftop time they did not deserve.

HOW THEY FAILED

- **Too oily.** Pleasant in the glass, heavy and slick once it was on skin.
- **Burned the nose.** Sharp in a way that made it unwearable regardless of how it smelled.

- **No longevity.** Correct at first spray and gone before midday.
- **Already exists.** Technically fine and smelling like a dozen things already on the shelf, which for a niche house is the worst of the four.

THE ALCOHOL DECISION

Most perfumery, including the French houses, works at 96% rectified alcohol. Marcus Aurelius works at **100%**. A litre costs approximately ten times as much.

The remaining 4% in a 96% base is water, and water is not neutral in a composition: it affects how the oils sit together, how the top notes release, and how the whole thing ages in the bottle. Paying ten times for the last four percent is not a rational decision on a spreadsheet. It is a decision about what the company is willing to have its name on.

Anyone can buy the same oils tomorrow. Nobody can buy two years.

VISION & MISSION

VISION

For Marcus Aurelius to stand among the world's recognised niche fragrance houses. Not a regional brand, but one that competes internationally on quality, identity and presence.

MISSION

Every detail, no matter how small, is reviewed and refined before it reaches the public. Developing a single fragrance can take up to two years to get the notes exactly right; a single social media post can take four or five days to reach the intended look. Precision and patience are not a side detail here. They are the foundation of the work.

The mission is deliberately stated as a working practice rather than as an aspiration, because it is already how the company operates and can be checked against the record: two years of development, thirty rejected formulations, and a soft launch that ran privately rather than publicly because the photography was not finished.

CORE VALUES

Precision

Every detail is reviewed multiple times before release, without rushing. The forty-day trial cycle is this value expressed as a process rather than as a sentiment.

Authenticity

No imitation, no cutting corners. Every fragrance is an original blend, which is why thirty of them were thrown away rather than adjusted into something that already existed.

Exclusivity

Not for everyone, by design. Built for those who can carry a strong identity. This is the value that governs distribution, not only composition.

Patience over speed

Time is treated as an investment, not an obstacle. Two years before the first sale was a cost the company chose to pay rather than a delay it suffered.

Confidence & pride

The brand sells a feeling of distinction, and that feeling shows in every decision, from the oil in the bottle to the refusal to let anyone else stock it.

How these are tested

A value is only real if it has cost something. Each of these has: the alcohol decision, thirty discarded formulations, and turning down retail placement that would have moved volume.

BUSINESS MODEL

Marcus Aurelius operates on a **Direct-to-Consumer** model, selling directly to customers through its own website and social channels, with no intermediaries. This preserves full control over the customer experience, from packaging to communication, and protects the exclusivity the brand is built on. Releases are produced in limited batches.

WHY NOBODY ELSE SELLS IT

The company does not wholesale, and does not intend to. This is the position most likely to be read as a limitation, so it is worth stating plainly why it is not one.

A shelf is a comparison. A bottle placed in someone else's shop stands next to another house's work, priced above it or below it. Whatever the customer concludes in that moment is a conclusion the company did not author and cannot correct. The composition took two years; the context it is judged in would take a stranger's shelf plan.

A shelf is also a duration. Stock that sits waits, and stock that waits collects dust. A customer who picks up a dusty bottle has learned something about the brand that is not true and cannot be argued with. There is no version of that encounter the company can recover from at a distance.

Retail, when it comes, will be ours. The expansion path is brand-owned boutiques, and the intention for them is not a shop but a room: a customer should feel they have walked into a Roman museum rather than a fragrance counter. That is not achievable in a metre of someone else's floor space, at any margin.

The fragrance is not the only thing being sold. The moment of encountering it is part of the product, and it cannot be subcontracted.

WHAT THE MODEL GIVES UP, AND WHAT IT BUYS

GIVEN UP	BOUGHT
Volume from third-party shelves and marketplaces	Every dinar of retail margin stays with the company
Passive discovery by shoppers browsing a perfumery	Complete authorship of how the brand is first met
Distributor relationships that would ease geographic expansion	No price erosion, no grey-market resale, no discounting by others
Faster scale in the first two years	An 87.9% gross margin at soft-launch pricing, rising to 93.9% at list

The trade is deliberate: this is a company that would rather sell fewer bottles at full authorship than more bottles it no longer controls.

UNIT ECONOMICS

Every figure in this section is real. Costs are fully loaded: oil, bottle, packaging, bags and label, per 100ml unit.

COST, PRICE AND MARGIN PER BOTTLE (JOD)

FRAGRANCE	COST	LIST PRICE	GROSS PROFIT	MARGIN
Romeo di Roma	5.50	90	84.50	93.9%
Roma Juliette	5.40	90	84.60	94.0%
Maximus	4.50	70	65.50	93.6%
Maxima	3.90	70	66.10	94.4%

WHAT THE COST FIGURES SHOW

The spread between the most and least expensive bottle to make is 1.60 JOD. That is a strategic fact rather than an accounting one: it means the collection could carry a single price across all four, which is what several established niche houses do precisely to signal that the collection rather than the individual product is the thing being sold. The current structure prices the two romantic compositions higher, which the oil content supports.

The oil itself is where the cost sits. The raw material for Romeo di Roma runs at 800 JOD per 100ml of neat oil and Roma Juliette at 650 JOD; only a few millilitres of it goes into a finished bottle, which is what brings the loaded cost down to five and a half dinars. Stated the other way round: the oil alone in Romeo di Roma is priced above a full bottle of most designer fragrance.

PRICING, AND THE SOFT LAUNCH

List prices are **90 JOD** for Romeo di Roma and Roma Juliette and **70 JOD** for Maximus and Maxima. The first two weeks of sales ran at exactly half those figures, 45 and 35, as a founding-circle price to friends and family.

> *This was a private round, not a public discount, and the distinction matters. A publicly advertised half-price launch anchors the market at the lower number permanently and teaches buyers to wait for the next one; a closed round at founder pricing does neither, because the market never saw it. The 45 and 35 figures appear in this document because it is a full disclosure of the record, and nowhere on the public site.*

BREAK-EVEN ON THE TWO YEARS

At an average loaded cost of 4.83 JOD and the soft-launch price mix actually achieved, each bottle contributed 34.17 JOD. Against 1,800 JOD of development spend:

36	68%	53
Bottles sold in the first two weeks	Of development recovered already	Bottles to clear it entirely

Seventeen more bottles at the same mix and the same founder pricing closes the whole two years. At list price the same threshold falls to twenty-five bottles in total.

REVENUE STREAMS

Three streams, all of them direct. Nothing is sold through a middleman, and nothing is discounted to move it.

01 DIRECT SALES · PRIMARY, ACTIVE

100ml Eau de Parfum, sold only from marcusscent.com.

No shop, no distributor, no reseller taking a cut. This is not a limitation being explained away: rent, retail markup and distribution margin are what normally consume the price of a fragrance. Removing all three is what allows the oil to be the expensive part, and it is the reason a bottle costing 5.50 to make can be sold at 90 without the buyer being exploited, because what they are paying for is the composition rather than the chain that carried it.

02 THE DISCOVERY SET · ACQUISITION, LAUNCHING

The full collection, four fragrances at 10ml each.

Ten millilitres is a size you can actually wear, not a vial. Nobody commits to a 100ml niche fragrance they have never smelled, and this answers that objection without ever quoting a lower price for a bottle: what the set costs is credited against the first full bottle the customer buys. The trial pays for itself, and a buyer who liked it arrives already paid up.

This is the mechanism that replaces discounting. It gives a reason to buy now without teaching anyone that the price is negotiable.

03 LIMITED NUMBERED EDITION · GROWTH, PLANNED

A fifth fragrance, made once. 100 numbered units at 300 JOD, reserved and paid before production.

Packaging will cost more than the oil, which is the intention: at this price the buyer should be holding the reason, not just wearing it. Payment at reservation funds the run, so nothing is manufactured on speculation and no capital sits in stock that has not sold.

One complete run is 30,000 JOD of revenue, which is roughly sixteen times the entire development spend of the company to date and twenty-one times the first two weeks of trading. It is scheduled for the growth phase rather than the launch, because a jump from a 90 JOD list price to 300 requires the 90 to be established in the market first.

Deliberately excluded: wholesale, marketplace listings, and any form of third-party resale. Section 07 sets out why. Also excluded is any revenue-share projection, since every other figure in this document is measured rather than modelled and a split would be the only invented number in it.

TRACTION: THE FIRST TWO WEEKS

A private soft launch at founding-circle pricing, before any public marketing existed and before the final photography was finished. No advertising spend of any kind.

FIRST FOURTEEN DAYS, BY FRAGRANCE (JOD)

FRAGRANCE	UNITS	PRICE	REVENUE	COST	GROSS PROFIT
Maximus	13	35	455	58.50	396.50
Maxima	9	35	315	35.10	279.90
Romeo di Roma	8	45	360	44.00	316.00
Roma Juliette	6	45	270	32.40	237.60
Total	**36**	**—**	**1,400**	**170.00**	**1,230.00**

36	1,400	87.9%	0
Bottles sold	JOD revenue	Gross margin	JOD spent on marketing

THREE THINGS THESE NUMBERS SAY

Development paid for itself before the launch did

The 1,230 JOD of gross profit covers 68% of two years of development in fourteen days. Seventeen more bottles at the same mix closes the remainder entirely.

The first SMART goal is nearly met before its clock started

Section 11 sets a target of the first fifty sales within three months of launch. Thirty-six arrived in two weeks, which is 72% of the goal in roughly 15% of the time, through a closed circle and with nothing spent on reaching anyone.

The sales mix confirms the seasonality independently

Maximus and Maxima, the two fresher compositions, accounted for twenty-two of thirty-six bottles: 61% of units, during summer. That is not a marketing assumption carried over from the market research, it is the company's own sales data agreeing with it, and it is a genuine input into how the two pairs should be timed and promoted.

AT LIST PRICE

The same thirty-six bottles at the public list prices of 90 and 70 would have produced 2,800 JOD of revenue and 2,630 JOD of gross profit, a margin of 93.9%. That figure is the one that matters going forward, since the founding-circle round is closed and will not be repeated.

SMART GOALS

Four goals, each set against the five criteria in full. The status column is the position as of August 2026.

GOAL 01 · LAUNCH AND FIRST SALE

Specific	Launch the online store and complete the first real sale, including final photography, product assembly and activating the sales channels.
Measurable	One completed public transaction through marcusscent.com.
Achievable	The site is live and all four fragrances are production-ready; only photography remains.
Relevant	Nothing else in the plan can begin until the channel is open.
Time-bound	Within 6 months.
Status	**Private sales complete; public channel pending photography.**

GOAL 02 · MARKET RESEARCH

Specific	Complete competitor analysis, target customer behaviour study and a final pricing strategy.
Measurable	Three deliverables, finished and documented.
Achievable	Global, regional and local analysis is already drafted; see section 14.
Relevant	Pricing cannot be finalised without it, and pricing governs everything downstream.
Time-bound	Within 2 months, before going to market.
Status	**Substantially complete; pricing set at 90 and 70 JOD.**

GOAL 03 · AUDIENCE

Specific	Reach 1,000 engaged social media followers as a customer base ahead of launch.
Measurable	1,000 followers, measured on engagement rather than count alone.
Achievable	Content is already produced in-house at four to five days per post.
Relevant	Instagram is the only marketing channel the strategy uses.
Time-bound	Within 6 months.
Status	**In progress.**

GOAL 04 · FIRST FIFTY SALES

Specific	Achieve the first 50 sales as an early signal of market acceptance.
Measurable	50 units sold.
Achievable	36 were sold in the first two weeks through a closed circle alone.
Relevant	It is the threshold at which the two years of development are fully repaid.
Time-bound	Within 3 months of launch.
Status	**36 of 50 reached in two weeks.**

ACTION PLAN

PHASE 1 · SETUP · LARGELY COMPLETE

Brand identity, all four fragrances production-ready with finalised packaging, a live website at marcusscent.com built custom rather than on a template platform, and an active Instagram presence. Remaining: final photography and asset consolidation before official launch.

PHASE 2 · LAUNCH · NEXT 6 MONTHS

Complete market research in the first two months, officially open online sales, run a structured social campaign, and target the first fifty sales within three months of launch.

No third-party retail placement at any stage. The bottle is never sold by anyone else and never stands on a shelf beside another house's work. Section 07 sets out the reasoning; it applies from the first day of trading, not only at scale.

PHASE 3 · GROWTH · POST-VALIDATION

Expand through brand-owned boutiques only, each built as a full sensory environment rather than a retail counter. Expand the product line, beginning with the limited numbered edition. Build a dedicated marketing and logistics team. Explore limited-edition creative collaborations, on the strict condition that no collaboration results in the product being sold by a third party.

Every phase is constrained by the same rule: the company grows by owning more of the chain, never by handing pieces of it away.

GROWTH STRATEGY

Marketing

High-quality visual content on Instagram rather than broad paid advertising. Scarcity itself is the instrument: the waitlist, the limited editions and the brand's own line create curiosity instead of reach. The first two weeks produced 36 sales on zero marketing spend, which is the argument for this approach rather than a happy accident.

Partnerships

Selective, carefully chosen collaborations only: luxury and fashion-aligned voices for exposure. Never third-party resale of the product itself, under any partnership structure.

Technology

The custom-built site remains the sole direct sales channel. Investment goes into the site experience rather than into listing on third-party marketplaces, which would surrender the customer journey and the pricing at the same time.

Expansion

Vertical, not horizontal. Brand-owned boutiques only, each designed as a full sensory experience rather than a shelf display, with later geographic expansion, particularly the Gulf, following the same fully-owned model.

WHAT VERTICAL EXPANSION MEANS IN PRACTICE

Horizontal growth would mean the same bottle in more places: distributors, perfumeries, marketplaces. It is faster, and it is available now. Vertical growth means more of the experience under the company's own control: its own room, its own staff, its own lighting, its own account of what the brand is.

The intended boutique is closer to a Roman museum than a fragrance counter, and that is not decoration. It is the only format in which the two years in the bottle can be communicated at the moment of purchase rather than left to a shelf tag.

MARKET ANALYSIS

GLOBAL

The global perfume market is valued at roughly $60–70B in 2026. Within it, the niche fragrance segment is the fastest-growing category, projected to reach approximately $4.85B by 2026 and growing at around 9.1% annually against roughly 2.7% for the mass market. Consumer research shows about 62% of buyers prefer niche fragrances over mass-market products, and premium gifting accounts for nearly half of niche demand.

Key global competitors: Maison Francis Kurkdjian, Creed, Xerjoff, Amouage.

MENA AND REGIONAL

The Middle East perfume market is valued at roughly $4B in 2026 and is projected to grow at approximately 7.5% annually. Fragrance is deeply embedded in the region's culture and hospitality traditions, and regional fragrance sales are growing at roughly 11% annually, with oud-based compositions growing over 20% year on year.

Leading regional players: Ajmal, Rasasi, Swiss Arabian.

The opportunity lies in the gap between traditional oud-heavy fragrances and Western-style niche perfumes: a space Marcus Aurelius occupies directly through blends like Romeo di Roma, which puts saffron and vanilla against oud and leather rather than choosing one tradition.

JORDAN AND LOCAL

Jordan's fragrance market shows rising demand for scents rooted in regional identity, and Amman itself has a dense concentration of perfume retail. Local competitors range from budget domestic brands offering imitation scents to international niche distributors selling at premium import prices.

The gap: no locally designed and produced brand currently competes at true international niche quality and identity. That is precisely the space this company was built to occupy, and the reason the oil sourcing runs through Europe rather than locally.

PRODUCTS

Four fragrances, four narratives, each produced in limited batches. The collection is built as two pairs, and each pair carries its own register inside the shared house identity.

MAXIMA · FOR HER · KINETIC PAIR

Top	Red berries, bergamot, sweet almond
Heart	Jasmine, rose, caramel
Base	Vanilla, white musk, woods
Benefits	Long-lasting wear, everyday luxury without heaviness, a distinct identity that sets it apart from mainstream perfumes.
Deliverables	100ml bottle, brand-identity packaging, small-batch production.
Economics	**Cost 3.90 JOD · list 70 JOD · margin 94.4%**

MAXIMUS · FOR HIM · KINETIC PAIR

Top	Orange, bergamot, lemon zest, sea breeze
Heart	Grapefruit, pink pepper, cedarwood, jasmine
Base	Leather, ambergris, sandalwood, white musk
Benefits	A balance of freshness and strength, strong presence without being overpowering, excellent longevity from the leather-amber base.
Deliverables	100ml bottle, Roman-aqueduct-themed packaging, small-batch production.
Economics	**Cost 4.50 JOD · list 70 JOD · margin 93.6% · best seller, 13 of the first 36**

ROMEO DI ROMA · UNISEX, LEANING MASCULINE · ROMANTIC PAIR

Top	Vanilla, saffron, pineapple
Heart	Leather, patchouli, caramel
Base	Oud, sandalwood, musk
Benefits	A rare pairing of saffron and vanilla against oud and leather: heavy and sensual without any banned additives, distinct from anything else on the market.
Deliverables	100ml bottle, Venetian-bell-tower-themed packaging, small-batch production.
Economics	**Cost 5.50 JOD · list 90 JOD · margin 93.9% · the first fragrance completed**

ROMA JULIETTE · FOR HER · ROMANTIC PAIR

Top	Saffron, jasmine, bergamot, mandarin, orange
Heart	Tuberose, red fruits, rose, caramel, almond
Base	Vanilla, tonka bean, white musk, amberwood, sandalwood
Benefits	The most complex and layered composition of the four, classic Italian opulence, exceptional longevity.
Deliverables	100ml bottle, packaging themed around the Romeo & Juliette narrative, small-batch production.
Economics	**Cost 5.40 JOD · list 90 JOD · margin 94.0%**

FIFTH, PLANNED

A limited numbered edition, made once, in a run of one hundred at 300 JOD, reserved and paid before production. Composition not yet fixed. See section 09.

THINKING METHOD

Six stages, each shown with what it actually produced in this company rather than what it means in the abstract.

01 DISCOVER

Identifying the real gap in the market: the space between overpriced originality and cheap imitation.

In practice: the founding question was not a business question at all. It was why no fragrance carried a particular set of notes. The market gap was found by wanting something that did not exist, then discovering that the reason it did not exist was structural.

02 DEFINE

Defining the identity of each fragrance beyond a nice smell: a persona, a story, a place.

In practice: Romeo di Roma and Roma Juliette are not two variants of one accord; they are two characters, and the packaging, the register and the colour treatment follow from that rather than from a colour system applied afterwards.

03 DESIGN

Designing the scent composition and the visual identity together, so neither feels separate from the other.

In practice: Maximus was photographed in water among lemon slices, and its visual register on the site is a beach-chair stripe. Romeo di Roma was photographed bound in rope and its register is a Venetian loggia. The image and the composition were decided as one thing.

04 DEVELOP

Up to two years of iterative formula development to get every note exactly right.

In practice: more than thirty formulations, each serious one requiring forty days before it could even be judged, and 1,800 JOD spent before a single sale. Four survived.

05 DEPLOY

A careful, unrushed launch. Nothing reaches the public before it has been reviewed and refined.

In practice: the launch is still private. Thirty-six bottles have sold to a closed circle while the public opening waits on photography that is not finished. The revenue was available; the standard was not met yet.

06 OPTIMIZE

Continuous refinement, down to how long a single social media post takes to get right: four to five days.

In practice: the specialists' advice to prove formulas on cheap oil first was refused, because optimising against the wrong material optimises the wrong thing. The same logic governs the alcohol at ten times the price.

BRAND IDENTITY

DIGITAL IDENTITY

Black background, cream text, muted gold accents, used for the website, social media and all online communication. Chosen to convey strength and quiet confidence without visual noise. The fragrance does not need loud colours to prove itself.

SWATCH	HEX	ROLE
Ink	#100E0B	Ground, everywhere
Cream	#F5F0E8	Primary reading colour
Gold	#C9A25C	Accent, headings, figures

PHYSICAL IDENTITY

Tan and bronze tones on packaging and labels, chosen to evoke the warmth of Roman stone, marble and aged bronze: a different emotional register for the moment the customer physically holds the product.

SWATCH	HEX	ROLE
Tan	#CBB08A	Packaging ground
Bronze	#8A6A3C	Label and edge detail
Gilt	#E0C48D	Highlight

WHY TWO PALETTES RATHER THAN ONE

The dual system exists because a brand and a product live in two different moments. Black and gold carry the digital first impression: a screen glanced at in seconds, where restraint and contrast do the work of standing out. Tan and bronze carry the physical unboxing: a slower, tactile experience where warmth and texture matter more than contrast. Neither palette is decorative; each is matched to how the customer is actually encountering the brand at that instant.

COLLECTION REGISTERS

Maximus and Maxima are the energetic pair: youth, motion and confident wildness. Romeo di Roma and Roma Juliette are the romantic pair: stillness, depth and restrained power. This is the same principle established houses use when a sub-collection is given its own visual register while the house identity stays recognisable underneath.

On the website the register is not confined to a card. The page itself takes the colourway of whichever fragrance the reader is standing in front of, navigation and index rail included, and returns to the house black and gold between them, so the collection reads as a passage through four worlds rather than as four separate websites.

RECURRING MOTIFS

The bust mark, the Greek meander border and the classical-serif-plus-script pairing recur across every touchpoint, digital and physical alike, tying the two identities together.

WEBSITE STRATEGY

The company's actual digital presence, built custom rather than on a template platform like Shopify, for full control over the user experience. Since it is the sole sales channel, it is not a marketing asset that supports the business; it is the business.

PAGE	PURPOSE
Home	Video hero with direct routes to the Collection and the brand Story.
Shop / Collection	All four fragrances with SKU, pricing, and both product and lifestyle imagery.
Story	The founding narrative.
Atelier / Ingredients	Editorial content on ingredient philosophy and craftsmanship.
Founders	Personal introduction to the people behind the brand.
Contact & Order Tracking	Direct contact channel and order tracking.

WHY CUSTOM AND NOT A PLATFORM

A template platform would have been faster and cheaper, and it would have imposed a checkout, a product-card layout and a visual grammar shared with several million other shops. For a company whose entire position is that the encounter with the product is authored rather than generic, that is the one saving that could not be taken.

PORTFOLIO APPEARANCE & DESIGN

PALETTE, AND WHY THESE COLOURS

Black and gold on screen, tan and bronze in the hand, for the reasons set out in section 17. This document uses the digital palette because it is read on a screen, with the body text lifted well clear of the ground: a website can afford dim cream on ink because the reader is skimming, and a forty-page document cannot.

TYPOGRAPHY

FACE	ROLE	REASON
Cinzel	Display, wordmark and headings	A Roman inscriptional capital, cut for stone. The brand is named after a Roman emperor.
Playfair Display Italic	Script accent, flourishes	Carries the Italian register without tipping into calligraphy.
EB Garamond	Body, long-form reading	An old-style book face; the only one of the three chosen for reading rather than for effect.

The classical serif wordmark and the script *Perfumes* pairing echo the brand's Italian, Roman-influenced aesthetic without leaning on cliché. The bust mark and the Greek meander border repeat quietly across every section, never shouting, always present, because exclusivity is communicated through consistency and restraint, not volume.

THE WEBSITE IS PUBLISHED IN THREE LANGUAGES

English, Arabic and Italian, switchable from the navigation. Arabic required its own typography rather than the house faces, since Cinzel, Playfair Display and EB Garamond carry no Arabic glyphs at all: Reem Kufi for display, because Kufi is the Arabic script cut for stone exactly as Cinzel is the Latin one; Amiri for reading, a revival of the Bulaq naskh and the nearest Arabic has to an old-style book face; Aref Ruqaa for the flourish.

ORGANISATION AND NAVIGATION

Seventeen numbered sections, indexed in a fixed rail on every screen and in a full contents overlay, so the reader always knows both where they are and what else exists. The numbering is Roman in all three languages, because it is structure rather than language.

GET IN TOUCH

Website

marcusscent.com

Instagram

@marcusscent

Email

info@marcusscent.com

Telephone

+962 78 124 3839

OPEN TO COLLABORATION

Retailers, photographers and creative partners who work the way this brand works are welcome to write. So is anyone who simply wants to know when the next batch is poured.

> *One condition, stated up front so it does not have to be negotiated later: no collaboration results in the product being sold by anyone other than the company. Everything else is open.*

The Mastermind Behind The Masterpiece

ABDULLAH AL-SALLAL

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